

First Read

Laopu Gold

Sales growth may decelerate but profitability could enhance YoY

Sales to decelerate; price raise and higher online mix could support profit

Market questions on sustainability post Q1 beat ([see our note](#)) and resulted in 9% share price correction. From Q2, we expect SSSG to decelerate, mitigated by increasing online sales mix and strong productivity of stores opened or expanded in 2025-26. We estimate that NPM for online channel is L-MSD higher than offline channel considering savings on rental and depreciation, which more than offset platform commission fee and a potentially lower GPM than offline. We introduced a scenario analysis for Laopu 2026 earnings forecast with three key drivers: 1) online sales mix, 2) same-store volume growth, and 3) productivity of new stores. Our base case comes to 55%/ 67% YoY growth for revenue/ net profit in 2026E, implying 20-30% growths in Q2-Q426E. Our upside/ downside case leads to 131%/ 29% YoY net profit growth.

Channel check update: negative 20-30% SSSG in March and April-to-date

Based on our observations and channel check, we noticed 20-30% SSSG decline in March and April-to-date in the Beijing high-base store, which achieved 50% growth in CNY holiday season. We attribute the decline to 1) weak gold price, 2) a shortened shopping festival (20 days in 2026 March-April vs c40 days in 2025 March-April), and 3) inventories that Daigou purchased in Jan-Feb before price raise have not yet been fully consumed. Both ticket size and transaction volume have declined. By consumer group, we noticed a deeper sales decline among Daigou than ordinary consumers. Demand from VIC consumers showed better resiliency than middle class and entry-level consumer groups. We view the trend in line with our expectation.

Near-term sector demand shifted by weak gold price

After reaching US\$5,300 in early March, gold price retracted to around US\$4,700 with near-term uncertainties from Middle East situation. This has pressured demand for fixed-price gold jewelry in the near-term, while supported demand for weight-based gold jewelry on a low base. Though we are in the latter stage of gold's bull cycle, UBS view on gold price to reach new highs remain unchanged ([see Global Precious Metals Outlook report](#)). We expect fixed-price gold demand to recover if gold price resumes the upward trend and that brands have presence outside of Mainland China to benefit more, considering the pricing gap post domestic VAT change.

Valuation: Buy rating; PT of HK\$930.0

Trading at 11x 2026E PE on a 6.6% dividend yield, we view risk reward of Laopu attractive. Our upside/ downside case suggest that Laopu is trading at 8x - 15x 2026E PE. Our DCF-derived PT implies 18x 2026E PE on the base case.

Equities

China
Retailers, Specialty

12-month rating **Buy**

12m price target **HK\$930.00**

Price (23 Apr 2026) **HK\$588.00**

RIC: 6181.HK BBG: 6181 HK

Trading data and key metrics

52-wk range	HK\$1,082.00-558.50
Market cap.	HK\$104b/US\$13.2b
Shares o/s	176m (ORD)
Free float	10%
Avg. daily volume ('000)	1,328
Avg. daily value (m)	HK\$915.4
Common s/h equity (12/26E)	Rmb15.6b
P/BV (12/26E)	5.8x
Net debt to EBITDA (12/26E)	0.3x

EPS (UBS, diluted) (Rmb)

	UBS	Cons.
12/26E	45.97	45.35
12/27E	52.49	55.86
12/28E	58.89	68.26

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Highlights (Rmbm)	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
Revenues	3,180	8,506	27,303	42,212	47,150	52,530	58,352	64,173
EBIT (UBS)	571	1,974	6,519	10,947	12,437	13,941	15,586	17,239
Net earnings (UBS)	416	1,473	4,868	8,136	9,258	10,387	11,619	12,860
EPS (UBS, diluted) (Rmb)	3.03	9.47	28.25	45.97	52.49	58.89	65.87	72.91
DPS (net) (HK\$)	0.00	6.35	21.34	38.93	47.16	50.88	57.58	64.45
Net (debt) / cash	(352)	(967)	(4,513)	(3,388)	(2,962)	(3,149)	(2,827)	(2,475)
Profitability/valuation	12/23	12/24	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E	12/29E	12/30E
EBIT (UBS) margin %	18.0	23.2	23.9	25.9	26.4	26.5	26.7	26.9
ROIC (EBIT) %	37.8	58.4	63.3	63.2	62.4	63.2	64.0	64.6
EV/EBITDA (UBS core) x	-	10.7	16.3	8.3	7.3	6.5	5.8	5.3
P/E (UBS, diluted) x	-	14.1	22.5	11.2	9.8	8.7	7.8	7.0
Equity FCF (UBS) yield %	-	(6.6)	(6.7)	5.4	8.1	9.0	10.3	11.6
Dividend yield (net) %	-	4.4	3.1	6.6	8.0	8.7	9.8	11.0

Source: Company accounts, LSEG Eikon, UBS estimates. Metrics marked as (UBS) have had analyst adjustments applied. Valuations: based on an average share price that year, (E): based on a share price of HK\$ 588.00 on 23-Apr-2026

We introduced a scenario analysis for Laopu 2026 earnings forecast with three key drivers: 1) online sales mix, 2) same-store volume growth, and 3) productivity of new stores. In Q126, we estimate that 1) online contributed to 20% sales (vs low-teens in Q125), 2) SSSG was around 50% where volume per same store was largely flattish, and that 3) sales per new store (those opened in 2025) were c60% higher than that of same stores (vs 30% lower productivity than same stores in 2025). In our upside/ downside cases, we assume 1) 30%/ 15% online sales mix in Q2-Q426, 2) same-store volume to decline by 20%/60%, and 3) new store productivity of 180%/120%. Our upside case implies 113%/ 131% revenue/ NP YoY growth. Our downside case implies 16%/29% revenue/ NP YoY growth in 2026E.

Figure 1: Scenario analysis with three key drivers

				Base case			Upside case		Downside case		
Rmb m	Q125	Q2-Q425	2025	Q126	Q2-Q426E	2026E	Q2-Q426E	2026E	Q2-Q426E	2026E	
Sales	8,000	23,383	31,383	19,500	28,641	48,141	47,352	66,852	16,894	36,394	
Revenues	6,960	20,343	27,303	17,000	25,212	42,212	41,904	58,904	14,950	31,950	
% online	13%	18%	17%	20%	20%	20%	30%	27%	15%	18%	assumption 1
% offline new store	14%	22%	20%	27%	30%	28%	28%	28%	26%	26%	
% offline old store	73%	60%	63%	53%	50%	51%	42%	45%	59%	56%	
# new store	8		16	11		14		14		14	
Monthly sales per new store	42	33	36	137	63	82	100	110	33	59	
# old store	29		29	35		35		35		35	
Monthly sales per old store	58	47	49	86	40	52	56	63	28	43	
New store productivity	72%	72%	72%	159%	158%	158%	180%	173%	120%	140%	assumption 3
SSSG of old stores				49%	-14%	5%	20%	28%	-40%	-14%	
price YoY				50%	50%	50%	50%	50%	50%	50%	
volume per same store YoY				-1%	-42%	-30%	-20%	-14%	-60%	-43%	assumption 2
GP	2,784	7,490	10,274	6,630	9,978	16,608	16,544	23,174	5,925	12,555	
NI	1,350	3,518	4,868	3,700	4,436	8,136	7,536	11,236	2,599	6,299	
GPM	40%	37%	38%	39%	40%	39%	39%	39%	40%	39%	
NPM	19%	17%	18%	22%	18%	19%	18%	19%	17%	20%	

Source: Company data, UBS estimates

Forecast returns

Forecast price appreciation	58.2%
Forecast dividend yield	3.3%
Forecast stock return	61.4%
Market return assumption	10.9%
Forecast excess return	50.5%

Company Description

Opening its first boutique in Beijing in 2009, Laopu was the first gold jewellery company in China to promote the concept of heritage gold. It also pioneered embedding diamonds in pure gold and introducing pure gold enamel jewellery. Laopu differentiates its products with innovative and complex craftsmanship. As of December 2024, Laopu self-operated 36 boutiques at high-end shopping malls in the mainland's high-tier cities, as well as in Hong Kong and Macau.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We base our price target on a DCF methodology.

We think key risks facing China's jewellery sector include: 1) a slowdown in China's economy, which could dampen consumers' spending on jewellery; 2) lab-grown diamonds could gain market share and intensify consumers' price sensitivity; 3) high volatility in gold prices may waver consumers' purchasing decision; and 4) competition from the Shuibei model, which sells retail gold jewellery at wholesale prices.

Company-specific downside risks include: 1) competition from other jewellers as consumers might not be able to differentiate their products; 2) fixed-price gold being criticised for its ambiguous pricing structure; 3) consumers may turn to imitation products at lower prices; and 4) the potential stock selling of cornerstone and other IPO/pre-IPO investors after their lock-up period.

Quantitative Research Review

UBS Global Research publishes a quantitative assessment of its analysts' responses to certain questions about the likelihood of an occurrence of a number of short term factors in a product known as the 'Quantitative Research Review'. The views for this month can be found below. Views contained in this assessment on a particular stock reflect only the views on those short term factors which are a different timeframe to the 12-month timeframe reflected in any equity rating set out in this note. For previous responses please make reference to (i) previous UBS Global Research reports; and (ii) where no applicable research report was published that month, the Quantitative Research Review which can be found at <https://neo.ubs.com/quantitative>, or contact your UBS sales representative for access to the report or the Quantitative Research Team on ubs-quant-answers@ubs.com. A consolidated report which contains all responses is also available and again you should contact your UBS sales representative for details and pricing or the Quantitative Research Team on the email above.

Laopu Gold

Question	Response
1. Is the industry structure facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting worse, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	3
2. Is the regulatory/government environment facing the firm likely to improve or deteriorate over the next six months? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting tougher, 3 = no change, 5 = getting better, N/A = no view)	4
3. Over the last 3-6 months in broad terms have things been improving/no change/getting worse for this stock? Rate on a scale of 1-5 (1 = getting a lot worse, 3 = not much change, 5 = getting a lot better, N/A = no view)	4
4. Relative to the current CONSENSUS EPS forecast, is the next company EPS update likely to lead to: (1 = negative surprise vs consensus, 3 = in-line with consensus, 5 = positive surprise vs consensus expectations, N/A = no view)	N/A
5. What's driving the difference?	
6. Relative to YOUR current earnings forecast, is there relatively greater risk at the next earnings result of: (1 = downside skew risk to earnings, 3 = equal upside or downside risk to earnings, 5 = upside skew risk to earnings, N/A = no view)	N/A
7. What's driving the difference?	
8. Is there an upcoming catalyst for the company over the next three months?	
9. Is there an actual or approximate date for the catalyst?	
10. Is the catalyst date an actual or approximate date?	
11. What is the catalyst?	

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Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	54%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

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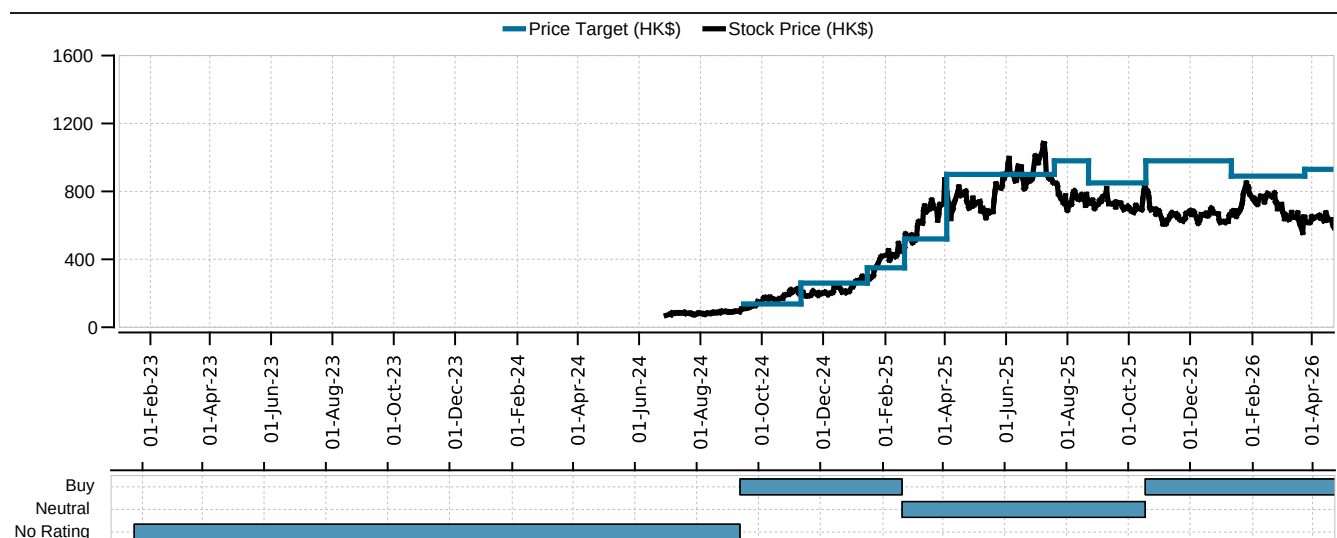
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Laopu Gold ¹⁶	6181.HK	Buy	HK\$588.00	23 Apr 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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Laopu Gold (HK\$)



Date	Stock Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)	Rating
2023-01-23	NaN	-	No Rating
2024-09-12	108.30	137.00	Buy
2024-11-08	208.20	260.00	Buy
2025-01-13	296.40	350.00	Buy
2025-02-19	474.00	520.00	Neutral
2025-04-02	799.00	900.00	Neutral
2025-07-18	852.50	980.00	Neutral
2025-08-21	751.00	850.00	Neutral
2025-10-17	828.50	980.00	Buy
2026-01-10	659.00	890.00	Buy
2026-03-24	648.50	930.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 23-Apr-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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